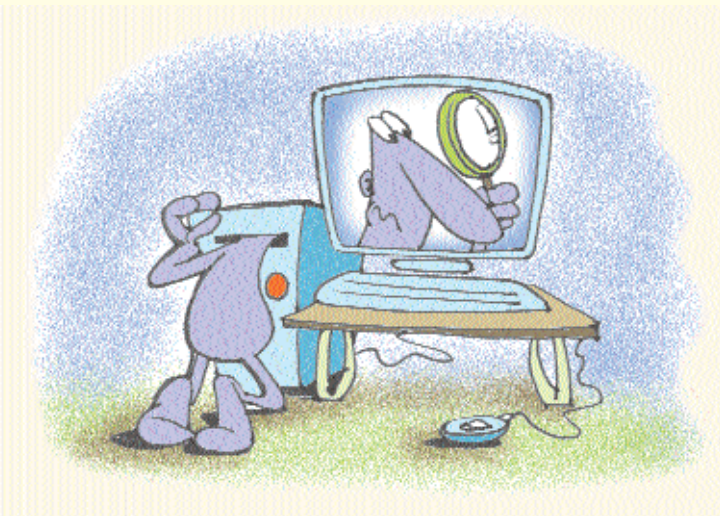




SEARCHING

Search toolbars

Download search toolbars provided by Google and Yahoo! and make them a part of your browser's toolbar. Type the search query directly in the toolbar. Netcaptor allows you to use shortcuts to directly search from the address bar. For example, typing **g digit** will automatically search for Digit in Google.

Browser plugins such as UCmore and Atomica are very useful when you are searching for specific

information. Both the Google toolbar and UCmore let you locate pages or Web sites that are similar to the ones that you are visiting at a particular point in time.

Girafa is a free browser add-on that provides a visual preview of Web sites thrown up by a search engine without requiring you to actually visit the Web sites.

Defining search criteria

In order to get accurate

results from a search, define the query in a proper manner so as to generate correct results the first time itself.

Using exact phrases: To find an entire phrase as it is, add quotes (" ") around the term. For example, "Digit India" returns listings where the words "Digit" and "India" appear together and in that order, either in the title, the URL, the description, the keywords, or the document.

Search for required words: Type the plus sign (+) or the word AND before a word for it to be found in all of the search results. For example, **Digit + India** (include a space between the first word and the + symbol) or **Digit AND India** returns all listings that contain 'India' and 'Digit' but not necessarily together.

Search by excluding: Use the minus sign (-) before a word or the word NOT for it to be not found in the search results.

Search for multiple words: Use the word OR for one or the other term to be found in the search results. To find documents containing the word 'Digit' but not the word 'India' or, for example, the word 'cricket', type **digit NOT (India OR cricket)**. You could also type this as **digit - (India OR cricket)**.

Using wildcards

An asterisk (*) indicates a wildcard search. This is useful when you are trying to match a term that may or may not be plural or might

use one of several verb tenses. For example, **physi*** will find results containing words that begin with 'physi' (like physics, physical, etc). You must have at least four non-wildcard characters in a word before you introduce a wildcard.

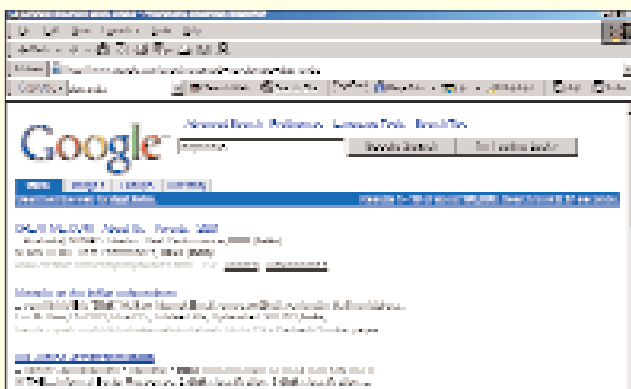
Some search engines support two wildcards. The asterisk (*) is used to replace multiple characters and the per cent (%) symbol is used to replace only one character. For example, **psych*ist** will find all results which contain words that begin and end with 'psych' and 'ist' (like psychologist and psychiatrist), and **gene%logy** will return sites containing words beginning with 'gene' and ending with 'logy', separated by a single letter (like genealogy and geneology) which is useful for commonly misspelled words.

Third-party searching aids

Third-party software such as Copernic 2001 allows you to obtain fast and relevant results from multiple search engines right off your desktop. Copernic searches 80 search engines which are grouped into seven categories. It does not display any broken links, and it also allows Web translation into seven different languages.

Secret tips for search engines

Google: If you want extremely quick results for your search, there's



Do the games on our Playware CD
give you an adrenalin rush?

Tell us about it and you could win a free Computers Arts Special on
Web Design 2.0

Just fill in our reader's research form at www.thinking.com/offers/back

